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STEADY PROGRESS
Prime Minister Fumio Kishida with Prime Minister Narendra Modi at Hyderabad House

T. NARAYAN/GETTY IMAGES

INDO-JAPAN TIES

A STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP DEEPENS

By Sujan Chinoy

Japanese prime minister Fumio Kishida's two-day visit to India, the first in-person summit since prime minister Narendra Modi's visit to Japan in October 2018, has succeeded in further consolidating the Special Strategic and Global Partnership in a year that marks 70 years of diplomatic ties.

The hiatus in summitry in the past few years notwithstanding, bilateral ties have greatly strengthened since 2014. As the chief minister of Gujarat, PM Modi had an excellent understanding of Japan's potential role in transforming the Indian economy. His personal friendship with Shinzo Abe not only stood the test of time but also laid an enduring foundation for the future. Abe's successors, prime ministers Yoshihide Suga and Kishida, were key players in that process.

Kishida's visit provided an invaluable opportunity to work in tandem for sustainable growth in a post-Covid world with focus on the Quad Vaccine Partnership, critical technologies,